

Brand BUZZ

Marketeers are going great lengths to create a buzz around products and attract eyeballs in an increasingly tough terrain where brand loyalty is almost past its date of expiry

By Malini Bhupta |

Eyeball attention is the name of the game. Haunted by fears of getting lost in the clutter, advertisers are pushing the limits to catch your attention. So when MTS Mobile—the ninth entrant into Delhi—launches, it gives commuters free run through the two toll bridges in the city for the day—October 9. The company prefers to catch consumers on the go over a high-decibel media blitzkrieg. From highways to elevators, advertisers are literally stalking their target audience as viewers take a commercial break from conventional advertising. From express trains being named after snacks manufacturers to entire malls being sponsored by telecom companies, the advertiser is clearly on the move.

Increasingly, brands are realising that traditional forms of advertising are no longer delivering the same value due to intense competition and if they have to sell the same old wine, then they better package it in new bottles. Advertising agencies are scrambling to come up with innovative ways to market products. With viewers becoming more and more promiscuous, brands are doing their bit to woo them. A PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC) report puts it aptly: consumers “want data to be available everywhere and all the time”.

As attention spans of consumers shrink, brands are fighting to keep pace with the screen-agers, who want information and entertainment on the go. Timmy Kandhari, leader of the media and entertainment practice at PwC, explains: “Against the backdrop of volatility in advertising spending, we are experiencing increased frag-

mentation of media and its audiences. This will result in advertising becoming more targeted, interactive and accountable.” No surprise then that MTS India did not adopt conventional methods. Traditional media is a follow-on strategy. Instead of carpet bombing viewers on multiple television channels, the brand pitched its promotion tents at the two toll roads connecting Delhi with Gurgaon and Noida. Given that almost 17 per cent of the country’s vehicular traffic is in the National Capital Region and with

60,000 cars passing through toll gates at Noida and Gurgaon during peak hours, the audience was guaranteed. Leonid Musatov, chief marketing officer of MTS India, says: “Traditional media guarantees minimum visibility, but it’s important to come up with innovative ideas that create buzz. New players need to clearly differentiate themselves to acquire customers.”

No wonder, advertising spends on mediums like radio, Internet and promotional activities are growing exponentially. There was a time when



Title Sponsorships: Brands can choose to associate themselves with entertainment properties exclusively by paying a premium so that the brand’s name is woven into the title.

Example: *India’s Got Talent* show with Maruti Suzuki in the driver’s seat.

Cost per season: Rs 15-20 crore